

What causes dyslexia?

Dyslexia comes from differences in how the brain develops and processes written and spoken language. It is about how the brain is wired, not about intelligence or effort.



DEVELOPMENTAL MOST COMMON

Most people with dyslexia are born with it.



Genetics

Dyslexia often runs in families. Many genes each play a small part, shaping how the brain develops the skills used for language and reading.



Brain differences

Brain imaging shows that dyslexic readers process written words differently. The connections on the left side of the brain that link speech sounds to letters can work less efficiently.



Early development

The chance of dyslexia is higher after premature birth or low birth weight, and after exposure to nicotine or alcohol before birth.

ACQUIRED RARE

Occasionally, reading difficulties start later in life.

This can happen after a brain injury, a stroke or an illness that affects the brain. It is called acquired dyslexia, and it is different from the developmental dyslexia most children have.

What dyslexia is not. Dyslexia is not a sign of low intelligence, laziness or poor parenting. Dyslexic children are often working much harder than their classmates to read the same page.

What this means for your child. Dyslexia is lifelong, but the right teaching makes a real difference. Structured, multi-sensory teaching builds the skills that do not come automatically, and helps children understand how they learn best.

NEXT STEPS IF YOU ARE WORRIED

1

Talk to your child's school

Share what you have noticed with their teacher or the school's SENDCo.

2

Book a free 20-minute call

Tell me what you are seeing, and I will explain the options.

3

Get a clear picture

A Learning Needs Assessment shows your child's strengths and what is getting in the way.

Yorkshire Wolds Dyslexia Service

Learning Needs Assessments · 1:1 literacy intervention
Pocklington, and within about 20 miles

ywds.co.uk

Member of the British Psychological Society and the Dyslexia Guild
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